



Security is the most important parameter that people consider when selecting IT infrastructure. Read about Zeek – an open source, flexible network traffic analyser that was earlier known as Bro. It is efficient, highly stateful and comes with open interfaces. This article explores the scripting component of Zeek.

Networks render critical services to users so it is mandatory to secure them. With every passing day, the number and nature of attacks made on networks is increasing exponentially.

Zeek, earlier known as Bro, was developed by Vern Paxson and Robin Sommer along with a strong team of researchers at the International Computer Science Institute at Berkeley CA and the National Centre for Supercomputing Applications in Urbana Champaign, Illinois, USA. Zeek is the result of 20 long years of intensive research. The speciality of Zeek is that it has the best of both academia and industrial practitioners backing it.

The main advantages of Zeek are shown in Figure 1.

- **Adaptable:** One of the prominent advantages of Zeek is that it provides a domain-specific scripting language. This makes it possible to establish site-specific security monitoring policies.
- **Efficient:** Zeek is aimed at providing security solutions

for high-performance networks.

- **Flexible:** It is different from other tools in that it doesn't depend on a specific detection approach. Another important point is that it is not dependent on traditional signatures.
- **Forensics:** Zeek's comprehensive logging enables forensics.



Figure 1: Zeek's advantages